SIGMA HOUSE
SRI LANKA

Website Strategy, Content & Development Brief

A modern, immersive, booking-focused website for international travellers

BRAND PROMISE
Experience Authentic Sri Lankan Village Life.

Prepared: October 2026
For Sigma House Sri Lanka only — with Nature Kitchen presented as one of the experiences offered by Sigma House.

1. Executive summary

Build a visually rich, trustworthy and easy-to-use website that turns international visitors into direct enquiries and bookings. Sigma House should be positioned as a welcoming Sri Lankan village stay and local-experience host—not simply a room listing or a generic tour operator. The site should let visitors imagine the experience, compare experiences and sample itineraries, understand what is included, ask questions on WhatsApp, and request a booking with minimal friction.

PRIMARY CONVERSION

Get a qualified booking enquiry through a clear “Plan Your Stay” / “Check Availability” journey, with WhatsApp as a convenient alternative.

What the website must achieve

- Explain the accommodation, village experiences, food, local culture and transport support clearly.
- Attract travellers planning Sri Lanka trips through useful search-friendly content.
- Convert interest into direct enquiries without forcing users to create an account.
- Build trust with genuine guest reviews, real photographs, transparent inclusions and clear contact details.
- Work beautifully on mobile, load quickly on slower connections and remain easy for the owner to update.
- Support future growth: more experiences, multiple languages, online deposits and partner referrals.

2. Brand strategy and identity

Brand positioning

Sigma House Sri Lanka is a local-hosted village stay and experience base for travellers who want to connect with everyday Sri Lankan life through food, gardens, people, nature and nearby places.

Brand elements

Brand name	Sigma House Sri Lanka
Main tagline	Experience Authentic Sri Lankan Village Life.
Voice	Warm, personal, grounded, welcoming, culturally respectful and practical.
Palette	Forest green #244A36; terracotta #B96545; warm gold #C49A4A; ivory #F7F3E9; charcoal #26312B.
Visual style	Natural light, real people, garden textures, food preparation, village details and candid guest moments.
Core promise	Stay locally. Learn by doing. Taste the culture. Explore at your own pace.

Brand architecture

Keep Sigma House Sri Lanka as the main website and primary brand. Present Sigma House Nature Kitchen as a signature cooking experience within the experiences section, not as a separate business website. The website should explain that visitors can book the cooking experience on its own or include it in a longer stay, depending on availability.

Audience segments

- Independent international travellers and couples looking for authentic local experiences.

- Food and culture travellers who want to cook, taste and learn rather than only observe.
- Slow travellers, nature lovers and visitors interested in rural life and local ingredients.
- Small groups, friends and families who need flexible transport and multi-day itineraries.
- Responsible travellers interested in community-based tourism and volunteering opportunities.

3. Recommended sitemap

Page	Purpose / content
Home	Brand story, hero video/photo, key experiences, stay overview, guest proof, sample itineraries and enquiry CTA.
Stay With Us	Rooms and facilities, room photos, guest capacity, amenities, food, check-in/out and booking enquiry.
Experiences	Overview of all activities with filters or categories and links to detailed experience pages.
— Village Cooking / Nature Kitchen	Hands-on Sri Lankan cooking, garden ingredients, spices, preparation, meal and practical details.
— Cinnamon & Spice Garden	Garden walk, cinnamon making, pepper, ginger, turmeric and other locally grown ingredients where available.
— Tea Experience	Tea factory visit and tea culture; state whether transport/tickets are included.
— Nature & Waterfalls	Waterfall visits, village walks and nearby nature outings; include seasonal/access notes.
— Culture & Village Life	Temple visit where appropriate, local traditions, village life and respectful visitor guidance.
— Tailor-Made Experiences	A flexible enquiry-led option for guests who want a custom itinerary.
Packages & Itineraries	Suggested 2-, 3-, 5- and 7-day plans with day-by-day inclusions and clear pricing status.
Transport & Rentals	Tuk-tuk, car/van arrangements and bike/car rental information, with capacity and licence/insurance conditions clearly explained.
Our Story	Host introduction, values, local community, garden and the reason Sigma House exists.
Guest Stories	Verified Google reviews, guest photos with permission, short testimonials and optional video stories.
Journal / Sri Lanka Guide	Useful destination guides, food stories, packing advice, culture and trip-planning articles.
FAQ	Food, payments, transfers, dietary needs, accessibility, weather, cancellation, arrival, safety and booking questions.
Contact / Plan Your Stay	Short enquiry form, WhatsApp, email, map, arrival instructions and response-time expectations.
Policies	Privacy, cookies if used, booking terms, cancellation/refund policy, terms of service and responsible-tourism guidance.

4. Homepage: recommended structure

1. Slim announcement bar

Optional seasonal note such as “Planning a Sri Lanka trip? Tell us your dates and we’ll help shape your village stay.” Do not use fake urgency or false scarcity.

2. Header/navigation

Logo; Stay; Experiences; Packages; Our Story; Journal; Contact. Keep one clear primary CTA: “Plan Your Stay”. Add a visible language switcher only for languages that are actually translated.

3. Hero section

Use a real, high-quality 5–10 second muted loop or a strong still photo: welcoming host, lush garden, cooking, local food or guests learning. Headline: “Experience the Sri Lanka you came to discover.” Supporting line: “Stay close to village life through local food, gardens, culture and nature.” Buttons: “Explore Experiences” and “Plan Your Stay”. Always provide a static image fallback.

4. Fast enquiry strip

Dates (optional), number of guests, interests (stay/cooking/nature/culture/transport) and a “Send enquiry” button. Do not imply real-time availability unless the site is connected to an accurate calendar.

5. Signature experiences

Show 4–6 beautiful cards: Village Cooking with Nature Kitchen; Cinnamon & Spice Garden; Tea Factory Visit; Waterfalls & Nature; Village & Cultural Experiences; Tailor-Made Itinerary.

6. Stay preview

Real room photos, what is included, food, amenities and a “View the Stay” link.

7. “A day at Sigma House” story

Use a simple visual timeline: arrive and enjoy king coconut (if offered), explore the garden, learn about spices, cook together, share a meal, then head out to explore nearby nature.

8. Sample itineraries

2-day, 3-day, 5-day and 7-day sample plans with realistic pace, travel time and “Customise this trip” CTA.

9. Why guests choose us

Personal hosting, authentic activities, local ingredients, flexible itineraries and direct communication—only make claims that can be supported.

10. Guest reviews

Embed or link to the genuine Google profile; show real, permissioned guest comments. Never invent reviews or ratings.

11. Gallery / short video

Optimised photos and vertical clips; captions explain what is happening, not just “beautiful Sri Lanka”.

12. Location and arrival

Map link, nearest practical arrival point, transfer enquiry and simple arrival guidance. Avoid publishing sensitive private details if not needed.

13. FAQ

Answer the questions that prevent booking: price, meals, duration, transport, dietary requests, payment, cancellation and how to get there.

14. Final CTA and footer

"Let's plan your village experience." Buttons for WhatsApp and enquiry form; contact, social links, policies and map.

5. Experiences to feature

Use experience detail pages with the same easy-to-scan template: story, photo gallery, duration, who it suits, what guests do, inclusions/exclusions, practical notes, price or "request a quote", available days, meeting point, cancellation policy and a booking CTA.

Village cooking experience — Sigma House Nature Kitchen

A hands-on introduction to traditional Sri Lankan cooking, local spices and familiar village techniques. Potential sequence: king coconut welcome (if offered), meet the host, learn about ingredients and spices, prepare selected dishes together, then sit down to enjoy the meal. Cooking sessions have previously been planned for Saturdays and Sundays, 10:00 a.m.–12:00 p.m.; reconfirm schedule before publishing. Mention dietary requirements in the enquiry form.

Garden-to-kitchen / spice garden walk

Explore ingredients growing in the garden, where available, such as cinnamon, pepper, ginger, turmeric, fruit and vegetables. Explain how ingredients are used in everyday cooking. Never promise a crop or harvest experience unless it is currently available.

Cinnamon-making experience

Introduce the local cinnamon process and its place in Sri Lankan life. State what visitors will actually do, whether the session is seasonal, and whether a specialist host or extra fee is required.

Tea factory visit

A guided tea-related outing to understand tea production and taste/learn about Ceylon tea. A previous estimate was around LKR 3,500 for a tea factory visit; confirm the current price, inclusions and transport before displaying it.

Waterfall and nature outing

A locally guided or arranged visit to suitable waterfalls and green landscapes. Provide trail difficulty, footwear advice, weather considerations, travel time and any entry fees where known.

Village, culture and temple visit

Offer respectful cultural context, visitor etiquette and clothing guidance. Temple visits should be optional and described accurately; explain any restrictions and photography etiquette.

Local food and shared meals

Show Sri Lankan meals and explain what is included in an overnight stay versus an extra experience. Ask about vegetarian, vegan, allergy and other dietary needs before confirming.

Multi-day village and south-coast itineraries

Create flexible itineraries that may combine village life, tea, nature, cooking and—where practical—places such as Weligama, Mirissa or Ahangama. Confirm actual location, transfer time, route and feasibility before selling.

Transport and rentals

Explain transport options and group suitability. A tuk-tuk may suit a small group (previous planning assumed up to three passengers, depending on luggage and local rules); arrange a car or van for larger groups. Confirm vehicle capacity, licence, insurance, fuel and driver terms.

Volunteering / community connection

Explain the exact activities, community partner, eligibility, fees, schedule and safeguarding arrangements. Do not promise volunteer placements until a real programme and partner have been confirmed.

6. Packages and itinerary presentation

Publish itinerary concepts first, then add confirmed prices once costs and inclusions are checked. Use “From [confirmed price] per person” only when the minimum group size, season, taxes, meals and exclusions are clear. If the price varies, use a short custom quote form instead of a misleading fixed price.

Package	Sample concept (not a final itinerary)
2 days / 1 night	Arrival and welcome; village/garden experience; cooking or cinnamon activity; local meal; one nature/cultural outing, depending on travel time.
3 days / 2 nights	A relaxed village stay with cooking, garden/spice learning, tea or nature outing and time to enjoy the accommodation.
5 days / 4 nights	Village-based experiences plus a carefully planned extension toward the south coast if location and transfers make sense.
7 days / 6 nights	A slower custom journey combining village stay, food, nature, tea/cinnamon, cultural stops and selected onward destinations.

Every package page should include: day-by-day plan; expected travel time; lodging and meal details; included and excluded items; group-size assumptions; weather/season notes; cancellation terms; and an enquiry button. Label these as sample itineraries until routes, partners and prices are confirmed.

7. Interactive features that genuinely help travellers

Trip builder / experience matcher

Let guests select dates or month, group size, trip length, interests (food, nature, culture, tea, cinnamon, volunteering), dietary needs and transport preference. Output a suggested enquiry summary—not an AI-confirmed booking.

WhatsApp enquiry with prefilled context

Every experience and package CTA should open WhatsApp with the page name and form selections included, so the guest does not have to explain everything again.

Booking request flow

A short form: name, email or WhatsApp, arrival date, departure date, guests, accommodation needed, selected experiences, dietary/accessibility notes, transport needs and message. Show a privacy note and confirmation state.

Availability calendar

Optional phase-two feature. Only show live availability when it is connected to a maintained booking calendar or property-management system. Otherwise use “Request availability”.

Transparent price builder

Optional quote calculator using owner-maintained prices, guest count, dates, selected activities and transport. Show an estimate clearly marked “indicative, subject to confirmation”.

Interactive map

Show the property and experience locations with accurate pins, realistic driving distances and directions. Do not invent journey times.

Guest stories and UGC

A gallery of authentic guest moments, short vertical videos and testimonials with written permission. Include captions and alt text.

Language support

Launch in excellent English first. Add German/French/other languages only when translated and maintained; use proper language-specific URLs and metadata.

FAQ search / helpful assistant

A simple searchable FAQ is a good first version. If an AI chat assistant is added later, ground answers in approved prices, policies and availability; make it clear that a human confirms bookings.

Accessibility controls

Keyboard navigation, visible focus, readable contrast, scalable text, labelled fields, captions, descriptive links and reduced-motion support.

Installable / PWA-like experience

Consider only if it adds real value, such as saved itinerary details or reliable repeat access. It is not essential for launch.

Email follow-up

With consent, send a confirmation of the enquiry and a human follow-up. Do not add visitors to marketing lists without an appropriate opt-in.

8. Design and user experience direction

- Create an editorial, premium eco-tourism look: large authentic photography, calm whitespace, earthy colours and warm human storytelling.
- Avoid generic resort templates, excessive animations, neon gradients, crowded layouts, fake counters and stock photos that do not represent the actual property.
- Use real photos and short clips from the property and actual experiences. Keep the first screen focused on one promise and two clear actions.
- Use consistent cards for experiences, but make every card explain the activity, approximate duration and next step.

- Keep navigation predictable and the most important CTA visible on mobile. A small sticky mobile action bar may offer “WhatsApp” and “Enquire”.
- Use subtle animation only when it improves comprehension; support reduced-motion preferences and never make essential text wait for an animation.
- Use high contrast and comfortable font sizes. Do not place important text directly over busy photographs without a solid/gradient overlay.
- Ensure image galleries have captions, keyboard support, and a way to close the expanded view.
- Use real people, hands preparing food, garden details, meals, rooms and the host. Obtain consent before publishing identifiable guests.

9. Website copy: ready-to-adapt examples

Homepage hero

Headline
Experience the Sri Lanka you came to discover.

Supporting text
Stay close to village life through home-style hospitality, garden ingredients, traditional cooking, local culture and nature. Tell us what you love, and we’ll help plan a more personal Sri Lankan experience.

Primary button
Plan Your Stay

Secondary button
Explore Experiences

About Sigma House

Sigma House Sri Lanka invites travellers to experience the warmth and everyday rhythms of village life. From local ingredients and traditional cooking to gardens, culture and nature outings, we help guests discover Sri Lanka through experiences shaped by the people and places around them. Every visit can be tailored to your time, interests and pace. Get in touch to plan your stay.

Treat this as draft copy. Personalise it with the host’s real story, village/location details, community relationships and facts that can be verified.

Experience card example

Village Cooking with Nature Kitchen
Learn about Sri Lankan spices, prepare traditional dishes with your host and share the meal you helped create. Ask us about available sessions, dietary needs and combining the experience with an overnight stay.

Trust copy

Use factual statements such as “Hosted locally”, “Custom itineraries available on request” or “Dietary requirements can be discussed before confirmation” only if operations can reliably support them.

10. Booking conversion and trust

- Put a booking/enquiry CTA near the top and repeat it after experiences, packages, reviews and FAQs.
- Show the total price or explain what determines the quote. State currency, per-person/per-group basis, minimum group size, included meals, taxes and extra fees.
- Make the next step explicit: “Send an enquiry — we’ll confirm availability and the final price.”
- Display a real response-time promise only if the team can meet it.
- Use genuine guest reviews and link to the source profile. Never manufacture review text, star ratings, guest counts or awards.
- Publish clear cancellation, refund, weather, safety, child, dietary and transport policies before taking deposits.
- Use HTTPS, spam protection, limited collection of personal data and a privacy notice.
- Offer secure online payments only after payment provider fees, refunds, settlement and operational processes are understood. WhatsApp/manual confirmation is acceptable for the first release.

11. Marketing plan built into the website

Search engine optimisation (SEO)

- Give every important experience its own useful page rather than hiding everything in one long page.
- Use descriptive page titles and headings based on real search intent, such as “Sri Lankan Village Cooking Experience”, “Sri Lanka Homestay with Local Food” and “[confirmed area] Village Experiences”. Never insert an unverified town name.
- Create helpful content that answers traveller questions: what happens in a cooking class, how cinnamon is made, what to pack for a waterfall, Sri Lankan food for beginners, and how to plan a village stay.
- Write unique meta titles/descriptions, descriptive image alt text, clean URLs, internal links and an XML sitemap.
- Connect Google Search Console and submit the sitemap; monitor which searches bring impressions, clicks and enquiries.
- Add appropriate structured data such as Organization/LocalBusiness and relevant lodging/experience information only where it accurately describes the real business. Validate before publishing.
- Keep name, address/location, phone, opening/session hours and website consistent with Google Business Profile and other listings.
- Do not expect structured data or SEO to guarantee rich results or top rankings.

Social and content marketing

- Create a reusable content system: short vertical videos, photo carousels, guest stories (with consent), practical travel tips and behind-the-scenes preparation.
- Make each post lead to a matching website page, not just the homepage. Use trackable campaign links where possible.
- Create video themes: welcome drink; garden-to-kitchen ingredients; spice close-ups; cooking steps; shared meal; host introduction; guest reaction; room and garden tour; nearby nature.
- Use natural audio and captions. Add English subtitles to spoken videos; do not rely on sound alone to communicate.

- Build a monthly content calendar around actual availability, weather, local events and experiences the team can deliver.
- Ask happy guests for an honest review after the experience, without offering rewards for positive reviews.
- Use email follow-ups and remarketing only with appropriate consent and privacy disclosures.

Paid marketing

- Start with a small test budget after the website analytics and enquiry tracking work.
- Test search ads for high-intent terms and social ads using real cooking/nature footage. Send each ad to a relevant landing page.
- Track cost per qualified enquiry and confirmed booking, not just views, likes or clicks.
- Retarget site visitors only when consent and platform requirements are satisfied; avoid tracking sensitive information.
- Pause campaigns that generate enquiries the business cannot serve or that cost more than the likely booking margin.

12. Measurement and analytics

Area	Measure
Discovery	Organic search clicks, impressions, landing pages, social referral visits.
Engagement	Experience-page views, gallery engagement, itinerary-builder starts/completions, FAQ use.
Leads	Enquiry submissions, WhatsApp clicks, phone/email clicks, enquiries by experience and country where voluntarily supplied.
Sales	Qualified enquiries, confirmed bookings, booking value, cancellation rate and enquiry-to-booking conversion.
Performance	Mobile load speed, Core Web Vitals, broken links, form errors and uptime.
Reputation	Review requests sent, new genuine reviews and recurring guest questions.

Install a privacy-conscious analytics setup and define conversion events before launch. Use consent management where required for non-essential cookies or advertising trackers. Keep a simple enquiry log so website leads can be connected to confirmed bookings.

13. Technical implementation brief

Recommended approach

Choose the stack based on who will maintain the site. A modern React/Next.js or Astro build is suitable for a custom, fast marketing website; a managed CMS can be better if the owner needs to edit experiences and blog posts without a developer. Avoid unnecessary complexity in the first version.

- Responsive design: mobile-first layouts tested on iPhone, Android, tablet and desktop.
- Performance: modern image formats (WebP/AVIF), responsive image sizes, lazy-loading below the fold, compressed video/poster image, caching and minimal third-party scripts.
- SEO: server-rendered or statically generated content where appropriate, semantic HTML, metadata, canonical URLs, sitemap.xml, robots.txt, Open Graph/social sharing cards and structured data.

- Security: HTTPS, secure form handling, server-side validation, spam/rate limiting, secrets in environment variables, dependency updates and backups.
- Content management: editable experiences, prices, seasonal notes, FAQs, journal articles, photos and availability/contact settings.
- Forms: accessible labels, clear error messages, success confirmation and email/WhatsApp notification. Test deliverability and spam protection.
- Integrations: WhatsApp link, Google Maps directions, Google Business Profile, analytics/Search Console and optional calendar/payment integrations.
- Accessibility: aim for WCAG 2.2 AA practices including keyboard access, visible focus, contrast, labelled controls, text alternatives, captions and sensible motion.
- Testing: broken-link checks, browser testing, form testing, accessibility checks, metadata/structured-data validation, page-speed tests and backup/restore test.

14. SEO metadata examples

Page field	Draft
Home title	Sigma House Sri Lanka | Authentic Village Stays & Local Experiences
Home description	Discover Sri Lankan village life through local hospitality, traditional cooking, gardens, culture and nature. Plan your stay with Sigma House Sri Lanka.
Cooking experience title	Sri Lankan Village Cooking Experience | Sigma House Sri Lanka
Cooking description	Learn about Sri Lankan spices and prepare traditional dishes with a local host. Ask Sigma House about cooking sessions and tailored stays.
Stay page title	Stay at Sigma House Sri Lanka | Local Hospitality & Experiences
Package page title	Sri Lanka Village Stay Packages | Sigma House Sri Lanka

15. Information and assets to collect before development

- ☐ Exact village/town, public address format and best arrival directions.
- ☐ Current room count, room types, maximum capacity, facilities, check-in/check-out times and current rates.
- ☐ Confirm whether the earlier estimate of LKR 5,800 per person per night including Sri Lankan food is still correct; define meals, taxes and other inclusions.
- ☐ Current prices and inclusions for cooking, cinnamon, tea factory, transport, rentals and all other experiences.
- ☐ Confirm cooking class days/times, duration, minimum/maximum group size, menu options and dietary/allergen handling.
- ☐ Exact 2-, 3-, 5- and 7-day itineraries with route times, supplier confirmations and seasonal caveats.
- ☐ Current WhatsApp number, phone number, email, Instagram, Facebook, TikTok and Google Maps / Business Profile URLs.
- ☐ Permissioned guest reviews, testimonials, photographs and videos; signed/recorded permission for identifiable people.
- ☐ Host story, team introduction, community partners and any volunteering programme details.
- ☐ Payment methods, deposit policy, cancellation/refund terms, privacy policy and emergency contact procedure.
- ☐ Logo files, brand fonts, real room photos, garden photos, food photos, short video clips and image credits/permissions.

16. Launch roadmap

Phase 1 — Foundation

Confirm business facts, rates, policies, photos, location and brand copy. Agree on the sitemap and enquiry workflow.

Phase 2 — Core launch

Build Home, Stay, Experiences, Packages, Our Story, FAQ, Contact and Policies. Add WhatsApp, enquiry form, map, basic SEO and analytics.

Phase 3 — Growth features

Add itinerary builder, individual experience landing pages, journal, review integration, email follow-up and translated pages as resources allow.

Phase 4 — Booking automation

If enquiry volume justifies it, connect a live availability calendar, payment/deposit flow, automated confirmations and a booking-management system.

Phase 5 — Optimisation

Review analytics monthly, improve pages with search demand, test CTA wording, refresh photos and refine the enquiry-to-booking process.

17. Acceptance checklist before going live

- A first-time visitor can understand Sigma House within 5–10 seconds.
- Every experience has clear activities, duration, inclusions, practical notes and a next step.
- No unconfirmed price, availability, review, award, distance or claim appears as fact.
- WhatsApp buttons work on mobile and desktop; enquiry form is tested end-to-end.
- Mobile navigation, gallery, forms and buttons are easy to use with keyboard and screen reader basics.
- Images are authentic, compressed and have meaningful alt text; video has a poster and does not block the page.
- All pages have page titles, descriptions, social previews and working internal links.
- Google Search Console, sitemap, analytics and conversion events are configured and tested.
- Privacy, cookies/tracking, booking, refund and cancellation information is published as applicable.
- The owner knows how to update prices, session times, availability notes, photos and FAQs.

18. Official reference links

Use these authoritative resources during implementation; the website brief above translates them into practical tasks for Sigma House.

- Google Search Central — SEO Starter Guide
- Google Search Central — LocalBusiness structured data
- W3C — Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) overview
- W3C — WCAG 2.2 standard

19. Current Sigma House contact details to verify

WhatsApp	+94 76 318 3081
Email	hasithadhananjaya2020@gmail.com
Instagram	@sigmahouse_srilanka
Google Maps	https://maps.app.goo.gl/yYRufBrzUXRY61Ea8

These details were previously provided for Sigma House and should be checked before the website is published. Confirm whether the email and phone should be public, and ensure the Google Maps link opens the correct main Sigma House listing.

Final recommendation

Build the first version around trust, real storytelling and a frictionless enquiry—not a large collection of features. The strongest differentiator is the combination of a village stay with hands-on experiences such as cooking, garden and spice learning, cinnamon, tea, nature and tailor-made local itineraries. Launch the core site quickly, measure which experiences generate qualified enquiries, then add more advanced booking automation only when the business is ready to maintain it.